

The Lingua Handbook

A small book for designing each page

LINGUA 6 · DESIGN

First edition, October 2026

Learn a language
by living in it.

LINGUA

This book is for whoever designs Lingua next: you, a friend, or a Claude on another account. It says what Lingua is like, so that every page can become a little more like it.

It lives in the repository at `docs/handbook`. Print it, scribble in it, and change it when Lingua changes.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

How to use this book

Read Part One once. It is short, and everything else follows from it.

When you sit down to design a page, open its chapter in Part Three. Every room fits on one page: what the room is for, what it shows first, what it keeps quiet, the one thing to do there, and three questions to ask yourself.

The exact things live in the margins. Colours, sizes, file names, springs and dates are written small, beside the sentence they belong to. You can read the book without them, and you can build from them without reading the book.

Before you call a page done, go through Part Four. Its review sheet is meant to be printed and ticked, one sheet per page.

At the back are every number in one place, the Latin names and what they mean, Lingua 6 at a glance, and a page for your own notes.

LIKE THIS

The exact things live out here, small, beside the sentence they belong to.

A few marks

in the margin	the fine print: exact values and where they live
~~*struck through*~~	something Lingua had and took out, kept so we remember why
☐	something to check
	a pause



THE WHOLE BOOK

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PART ONE

The spirit

What Lingua is, how it behaves, and how it talks.



CHAPTER 1

What Lingua is

Lingua is a place to live in a language for a while. You read in it, listen to it, watch it, talk and write in it, and every word you meet is kept, so it comes back just before you would have forgotten it.

THE TOKENS

`src/design/tokens.css`, "Cozy Scriptorium design tokens".

It is not a game and it is not a school. It is closer to a study at home: a desk by the window, a shelf of books, a pot of tea going cold because the chapter got good. That is why its design is called the Cozy Scriptorium.

ORDER

`src/app/sections.ts`. Alt 1 to 8 opens them in this order. Ratio and Settings sit apart at the bottom of the sidebar.

The rooms have Latin names, because a scriptorium would have used them, and because it is a little bit fun. Each room keeps one kind of work:

Home	your hearth: today, and what's next
Cursus	the course, grammar, alphabets and typing
Codex	reading: books, articles, comics
Thesaurus	every word you keep, and Ludus, the games
Sonus et Visio	listening and watching
Mentis	the guide, talking and writing
Ratio	how it's going
Settings	everything you can change

DESKTOP ONLY

Since 2026-10-20. The user: "Phone is not needed anymore." What exists for the phone stays; nothing new is made for it.

Lingua is made for the desktop. It uses a wide window the way you use a desk: things side by side, nothing stacked that could sit next to each other.

CHAPTER 2

Six habits of a Lingua page

Six habits, more than rules. A page that has all six usually needs nothing else.

I. The language comes first

On every page, the language is the biggest, best-set thing there is. A sentence in German gets the serif, the space and the light; the buttons around it step back. If a page has nothing in the language on it, ask whether it should.

SET IN

Titles in Literata. Reading text in the learner's own reading font, one of six.

II. Quiet until asked

Show the one thing that matters and keep the rest a click away: details in a drawer, numbers on hover, options under More. Control is never taken away, only folded. Whoever wants every setting finds it; whoever doesn't never has to see it.

BUT

Nothing important lives only on hover. Whatever a hover shows, a click or a key shows too.

III. One word, everywhere

A word saved while reading is the same word in Thesaurus, in Ludus, in a talk in Sermo and in Ratio's counts. Design as if each word were a small thing the learner carries from room to room, and let it remember where it was found.

WHERE WORDS LIVE

The word memory and the dictionary, Thesaurus › Dictionary (4.0-2).



IV. Honest, never hopeful

TAKEN OUT

2026-10-26: the first start's "B1 in about 7 months" and its pace verdicts. Not accurate enough to say.

Say only what is true and built. No forecasts Lingua can't keep, no scores that look precise and aren't, no features promised before they exist. When Lingua doesn't know, it says so plainly, or says nothing at all.

V. The learner holds the pen

BORROWED

From the Lingyu blueprint (2026-10-25): "saving is not scheduling"; anything generated is editable and can be dismissed.

Whatever Lingua decides for you can be undone: a word marked known can be unmarked, a level changed, a card edited. Nothing large happens behind the learner's back. Saving a word is not the same as scheduling it, and one click never quietly grows a deck of fifty.

VI. Wide and calm

SIZES

Check at 1280, 1440 and 1366 × 768. Shortcuts: Alt 1–8 for the rooms; the rest in the Shortcuts dialog.

Use the width: columns, side panels, sticky rails, a list beside its detail instead of a page after it. Every page fits a 1366 × 768 laptop with no little scroll bar sneaking in. The reader and long lists are the only things that scroll, and they do it on purpose.

If you only remember one: the language first, everything else quiet.



CHAPTER 3

The voice

Lingua talks like a friend who reads a lot: informal, warm, a little dry. It likes to make you smile, but never at the cost of being clear.

One smile per page. A funny subtitle is a gift; three of them are a stand-up set. The joke goes where nobody has to read it to act: a subtitle, a quiet line under a field. Never inside an instruction.

Titles ask or name. "What language will it be?" "So, how far along are you?" "Choose your study light." Short enough to take in at a glance, and a real question when there is one.

Buttons say what happens. "Continue with Deutsch" says more than "Next". One main button per page.

Plain where it matters. Money, privacy, errors and deleting get the plainest words in the app. "Could not save your choices. Please try again."

Small manners. British spelling, as in colour and favourite. Curly quotes, and the language's own quotation marks when its touches are on. No exclamation marks in the interface; the welcome toast may keep its one.



THE USER'S OUTLINE

For the first start: "minimal, informal, bookish, building up the excitement, with funny subtitles" (5.1–2b).

REAL LINES

From `Onboarding.tsx`: the error above, and the welcome toast, "Welcome to Lingua, {name}. Happy reading!"

MARKS

« French » · „German“ · 「Japanese」

Said, and rather not

Lingua's own lines on the left. The struck-through ones were in Lingua and were taken out.

WE SAY	WE'D RATHER NOT
What language will it be?	Select your target language
Continue with Deutsch	Next
8 of 15 minutes	53% of your daily goal complete!
It stays on this device. We just like to be polite.	We value your privacy.
Click a country to see what's spoken there, or scroll down for all of them.	~~… Commitment issues welcome: you can add more later.~~ A joke inside an instruction.
(nothing, when Lingua can't know)	~~At 15 minutes a day, B1 in about 7 months.~~ A forecast it couldn't keep.
Your shelf is empty. Import a book, or take one from the library.	No items found.
None of Lingua's languages is spoken in {country} yet.	No results.

FOR EXAMPLE

"Your shelf is empty …" is an example of the voice, not a line in the app.

Read your page aloud in the voice of someone who likes you. If a sentence would sound strange said to a friend across a table, change it.



PART TWO

The materials

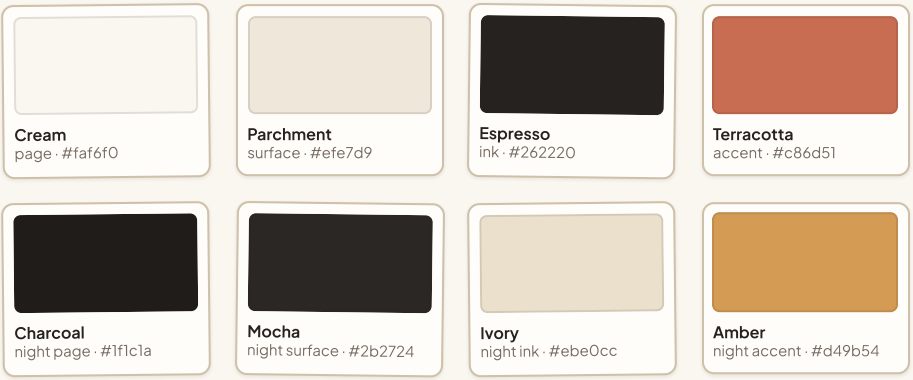
Paper, ink, type, space, motion, and the little drawings.



CHAPTER 4

Paper and ink

Lingua's light is called Paper and its dark is Nocturne. Neither is the other turned inside out: Paper is cream with espresso ink, Nocturne a warm charcoal with ivory, so nothing is ever pure white or pure black.



TEXT IN THE ACCENT

Use `--accent-text` (#a5533b), which keeps 4.5 : 1 on cream. `--accent` itself is for decoration in Paper.

SAGE

#6b8e78; its text #4f6f5b. At night #93b39e.

INVERSE

#3b302a on #f8efe0; at night #e8d8bb with #2b231e.

The accent is a bookmark, not a highlighter. One terracotta thing per area: the chosen language, the next step, the new word. If two things on one card are terracotta, one of them is wrong.

Sage means known, done or growing: a ticked step, a word you know, a finished chapter.

Tooltips, toasts and main buttons are inverse: espresso with cream by day, old-paper cream with espresso at night. Never black, never white.

Palettes and reading papers

The learner picks a palette for each light, and a paper for reading in Codex. Design in Cream and Charcoal, then look at one more of each before you call it done. A page that only works in Cream isn't done.

PAPER



NOCTURNE



Reading papers, by day: Cream, Ivory, Parchment, Sepia, Sage, Blush and Stone. By night: Charcoal, Espresso, Sepia night, Ink, Forest, Plum and Midnight. The paper turns with the light, in the same transition.

Use the tokens, never a colour by hand. A palette swaps the page, the surfaces and the accent. A colour typed in by hand is right in one palette and wrong in eleven.

WHERE

`src/design/palettes.ts`, `src/design/papers.ts`. The first of each list is the original look.

CONTRAST

Each palette's accent text is chosen to keep 4.5 : 1 on its own page. Ink keeps the theme's own.

TOKENS

`--bg --surface --raised --sunken --ink --ink-soft --ink-faint --line --line-strong --accent --accent-text --accent-fill --sage`

CHAPTER 5

Type

Two voices. Literata is the book: the titles, the language, and the numbers that matter. Plus Jakarta Sans is the helper: labels, buttons, explanations. When in doubt, ask who is speaking.

LITERATA

Am Abend lasen wir am Fenster, während draußen leise Schnee fiel.

PLUS JAKARTA SANS

Continue with Deutsch · Click a country to see what's spoken there.

WHERE	FACE	SIZE
Big moments (your name, the welcome)	Literata 600	40–44 px
A page's title	Literata 600, tight	30–36 px
A line in the language	Literata	19 px
Body and buttons	Jakarta	15 px
Small lines under things	Jakarta	12.5 px
Labels, in capitals	Jakarta 700, +0.08 em	11.5–12 px

WHERE

`--font-serif`, `--font-sans` in `src/styles/index.css`; reading fonts in `src/design/fonts.ts`.

The learner picks the reading font, so design for all six: Literata, Lora, Newsreader, Merriweather, Atkinson Hyperlegible and Comfortaa. Scripts they don't cover fall back to Noto Serif SC, JP and KR, Noto Naskh Arabic, or the device's own faces.

Numbers in a table line up (tabular). Numbers in a sentence are the book's own, set in the serif: "8 of 15 minutes".

CHAPTER 6

Space, corners and light

A Lingua page breathes like a well-set book: generous margins, one clear column, and things grouped by space before they are grouped by boxes.

Lines before shadows. A hairline separates; a shadow lifts. Most things only need the line. When something does float, one shadow is enough, and it is warm, never grey.

LIGHT

elev-1 a card at rest · **elev-2** something floating: the map, a popover · **elev-3** dialogs and drawers. All tinted espresso.



Round, not bubbly. Pills for small choices, generous corners for cards and dialogs, gentler ones inside them. An inner corner is always smaller than the one around it.

TAILWIND

Buttons `rounded-lg/xl/2xl` by size; cards and dialogs `rounded-3xl`; empty states `rounded-2xl`.

One screen. A desktop page fits 1366 × 768 without a scroll bar. If it doesn't fit, take something away before making something smaller.

SINCE

2026-10-25, `5c044f9`: desktop screens on one screen, no tiny scroll.

Columns over stacks. A sticky rail for filters, a panel beside a list, two cards side by side that end on the same line.

CHAPTER 7

Motion

Things in Lingua settle like paper: they move a little, then they are still. Motion says where something came from. It never performs.

SPRING	FOR	STIFFNESS · DAMPING
snappy	pills, toggles, indicators	560 · 42
soft	cards and page content	320 · 34
sheet	drawers and sheets	400 · 40
gentle	the first start's pages	200 · 28
fluid	full motion: pages, reordering	210 · 26

WHERE

`src/design/motion.ts`; the rules in `docs/PERFORMANCE.md`.

FULL MOTION

A setting: pages rise 18 px and settle on *fluid*.

Only transform and opacity move. Never a width, a height or a top: the reader has to stay at sixty frames a second.

The first start turns its pages, 48 pixels sideways with a six-degree tilt. Elsewhere, pages rise 8 pixels as they appear.

Reduced motion means none, not less.

Nothing is slower than the learner. If they click again before something has finished moving, the second click wins.



not this slow

CHAPTER 8

Drawings, icons and flags

Drawings are one fine line in the colour of soft ink, with one small thing in terracotta: a bookmark, a tick, a wisp of sound. They are small, and they never explain what the words already say.

THE LINE

Stroke 1.3, round caps and joins, `currentColor` in `ink-soft`. See the open book and the three vignettes in `IntroPages.tsx`.



Icons are Lucide, as lines. A room keeps its icon wherever it appears: the sidebar, Home, a link from another room.

Flags are drawn, all the same size and corner. Where one country's flag would be wrong for a language, it gets its own emblem (the Senyera for Catalan, the Ikurriña for Basque, the Frisian flag) or a badge with its script on soft paper: ਪੰ for Punjabi, Š / Ћ for Serbo-Croatian, सं for Sanskrit, ᚱ for Old Norse.

An empty page may have a drawing. A full page doesn't need one.

THIS BOOK

The little room drawings here are for the book only. In the app, the rooms use their Lucide icons.

WHERE

`src/design/flags.tsx`. Script badges set the glyph in the reading font on a paper square, so they sit calmly beside real flags.

A touch of the language

WHERE

`src/design/flavours.ts`, on by default: Settings › Look and feel › Language touches.

When you learn French, Lingua looks a little French. Each core language lends the app a heading face, one ornament and a lean of the accent. It is a touch, not a costume: the reading text and the learner's palette never change.

LANGUAGE	HEADINGS	ORNAMENT, AND MORE
French	Garamond	a fleuron, a hint of bleu de France
Spanish	Alegreya	a tile strip; ¿ in titles that ask
German	a clean grotesque	a straight rule
Russian	PT Serif	a thin red rule
Mandarin	a Song face	a vermilion seal for "done"
Arabic	Amiri	an eight-point star

QUOTES

In the language's own marks: « » for French, „ " for German, 「」 for Chinese and Japanese.

Where the touch shows: room titles, Home's greeting, dividers, empty states, the end of a book, the loading screen, and the first start once a language is chosen. Never in the text being read.

When you design a page, switch through the six. If the touch makes anything harder to read, the touch is wrong, not the page.



PART THREE

Page by page

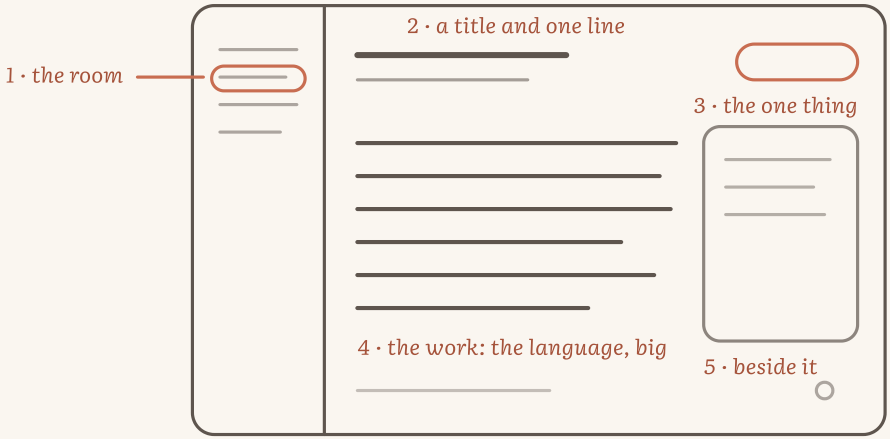
The anatomy of a page, the first start, and every room, one page each.



CHAPTER 9

The anatomy of a page

Most Lingua pages are made of the same five parts. Get these right and the page is nearly done.



USE THESE FIRST

Button, Card, Dialog, Drawer, EmptyState, Popover, SearchInput, Segmented, Select, Slider, Switch, Tooltip: `src/design/primitives`.

1. **The room,** lit in the sidebar. Nothing else tells you where you are.
2. **A title and one line.** The title in Literata; the line under it in the helper's voice, and that's where a smile goes.
3. **The one thing to do,** in the accent fill, top right or under the work. One per page.
4. **The work.** The language, a list, a player: the biggest, calmest thing.
5. **What's beside it, and the quiet edges:** a panel or rail; counts, More, settings.

CHAPTER 10 · LINGUA 6 BEGINS HERE

The first start

The first start is the first page of the book. It should feel like opening one: unhurried, a little exciting, and over before it gets long.

Your name · Welcome · What Lingua can do · Language · Level · ~~You speak~~ · ~~Why~~ · Goal · Study light · Plans

Three pages to say hello, then four steps to set up, and the plans. “You speak” and “Why” were taken out: the fewer questions before the first page of reading, the better.

Your name

“First things first.” One field for a first name, and Continue waits until there is one. No skip. The quiet line stays: “It stays on this device. We just like to be polite.”

The language

The world first, wide. Click a country, and a panel opens with the country itself as its title, its flag and its name, set properly, then the languages you can learn there. No tabs. Under the map, the six core languages as small book covers, each wearing a touch of its language; under them every other language, larger than before, by tier. Each tier says plainly what it has and what it doesn’t have yet.

THE PLAN

Lingua 6-1 in `docs/LINGUA-6-PLAN.md`, from the user’s notes of 2026-10-26. Code: `src/app/onboarding`.

DOTS

Only the steps get dots, not the hello pages. Every page fits 1366 × 768, except the language page, where the list peeks in on purpose.

OUT

“Skip for now”, and the Lingua mark above the title: the header already has the wordmark.

TIERS

Core · Full · Beta · Basics · Experimental. One table, `TIERS` in `src/core/lang/languages.ts`, with *has* and *not yet*.



The level

THE CARD

Springs in on *snappy*; arrow keys move along the steps. From A2 up it says the most common words start as known.

Seven steps, A0 to C2, like a staircase. Hover one or choose it, and a small card pops up with what that level could mean: what you can read, follow and say there, and what Lingua will do about it. No example sentences, no test.



The goal

OUT

~~"B1 in about 7 months"~~, ~~"Ambitious. We like it."~~ Not accurate enough.

A level to aim for, and minutes a day. Nothing forecasts. Instead each choice says what it means: the goal in the level card's words, the minutes in what they hold in Lingua: "Cards, a few pages and a song."

Study light, and the plans

PLANS

`features/plans/PlanPitch`. Max shows monthly first.

Every palette as a small page of the app, with Follow my device first. Then the plans, which promise only what is true, with Continue free as clear as the rest.

Ask yourself

1. *Can someone reach the map in under a minute?*
2. *Does any page promise something Lingua can't measure?*
3. *Is there more than one joke on a page, or one inside an instruction?*

CHAPTER 11

Home

Your hearth



Coming home to the language: what you did today, and the one thing to do next.

SHOW FIRST	The greeting by name, today's minutes against the goal, and Next up.
KEEP QUIET	The week and its numbers, the Lingua+ button (free plan only), first steps once they're done.
THE ONE THING	The first row of Next up.

Home is a page you glance at, not one you study. A returning learner should be back in their book within a click, without reading a word of the interface.

TODAY

"Good evening, {name}"; minutes in serif numerals, "8 of 15 minutes", over a ribbon split by room. Next up: at most four rows. `features/home/HomeToday.tsx`.

Ask yourself

1. *Can a returning learner start in one click, without reading?*
2. *Is anything below fighting Next up for attention?*
3. *Does a brand-new learner see a way in, rather than empty numbers?*

ALSO

Home layout Today / Classic in Settings › Look and feel. Both columns end on the same line.



CHAPTER 12

Cursus

The course, grammar, alphabets and typing

Learning in order, for those who like a path: it leads, and everything stays open.

SHOW FIRST	The next point on the trail.
KEEP QUIET	Everything past the next few steps. Any topic can still be opened; it just isn't pushed.
THE ONE THING	Continue.

TABS

Course · Grammatica · Alphabets · Typing, keys 1–4, opening on the tab used last. The course is for the six core languages; the path became an adventure in 5.1-3.

A grammar rule is easiest to keep when it comes with a sentence you have already met. Wherever Cursus can, it borrows from what the learner read or heard.

Ask yourself

1. *Is the next step obvious, and is everything else still within reach?*
2. *Does a rule show a sentence the learner has actually met?*
3. *Does a lesson end by pointing back into reading or listening?*

DECIDED

D10 of the 5.1 plan: "It leads, everything stays open."

CHAPTER 13

Codex

Reading



Reading real things in the language, with every word a tap away. The heart of Lingua.

SHOW FIRST	The book you're reading. In the reader, the page and nothing else.
KEEP QUIET	Translations, grammar and the dictionary, in the word drawer, once a word is tapped.
THE ONE THING	Keep reading.

The reader is the one page that should feel like paper and nothing more. Words you are learning are marked kindly, not like mistakes; words you know are not marked at all.

Ask yourself

1. *Is the text the biggest, calmest thing on the screen?*
2. *Does closing the drawer put you back on the very word you tapped?*
3. *Does the end of a book feel like the end of a book?*

MARKS

New words on `--learning-bg` with `--learning-line`; unseen ones a sage line. Styles in `src/styles/reader.css`; papers per light.

ALSO HERE

Import a book or a comic; the end page with its ornament; the reading goal's note.



CHAPTER 14

Thesaurus and Ludus

Your words, and games with them

Every word you keep, and the practice that brings it back just in time.

SHOW FIRST	The cards due today, and the words you met most recently.
KEEP QUIET	The scheduling: intervals, ease, forecasts. There for those who look.
THE ONE THING	Study what's due.

CARDS

Width Thin · Normal · Wide, per deck if wanted. Discover; sentences with a gap as a Ludus mode; the word memory and the dictionary.

A word is more than its card. Wherever it shows, let it say where it was found: the book and the sentence, the song and the line.

Ask yourself

1. *Does every word show where it came from?*
2. *Is a card's answer hidden until the learner has tried?*
3. *Does practice end with a calm summary rather than a score to beat?*

CAREFUL

A saved word is not a known word. Count them separately, everywhere.

CHAPTER 15

Sonus et Visio

Listening and watching



Podcasts, radio, audiobooks, songs, films and shows, with the text following along.

SHOW FIRST	Continue: what's half-played or half-watched, and how much is left.
KEEP QUIET	Sources and services and their limits, until they matter. Then say them plainly.
THE ONE THING	Press play.

Only one thing plays at a time. A word looked up mid-song pauses the following, not the song, and the learner can find their line again with one click.

Ask yourself

1. *Can you look up a word without losing your place?*
2. *When a service can't do something, does the page say so instead of showing a dead button?*
3. *Is an empty library one calm card, not a wall of empty shelves?*

STRIP

+ Listen and + Watch; Library · Audiobooks · Radio · Streaming, and Sonus+ at the end. A sticky rail of categories in the library.

HONEST

Never imply Lingua includes someone else's subscription.



CHAPTER 16

Mentis

The guide, talking and writing

Using the language: Mundus suggests, Sermo talks, Diarium writes.

SHOW FIRST	Today's prompt: one thing to write, one thing to talk about.
KEEP QUIET	Scores and corrections, until the learner asks for them.
THE ONE THING	Start today's prompt.

AI

With the learner's own key (Groq, Gemini), and only with Max. A privacy note sits next to Check.

What the learner writes or says is theirs. Corrections sit beside the original, never over it, and each one can be taken or left.

Ask yourself

1. *Are the learner's own words still visible next to the corrections?*
2. *Is it clear what is sent away, and to whom, before anything is sent?*
3. *Can a talk or an entry be left half-done and found again?*

TABS

Mundus · Sermo · Diarium, with Today's prompt on the right of each.

CHAPTER 17

Ratio

How it's going



An honest look back: time, words, reading, listening, and the journey so far.

SHOW FIRST	This week, in a few numbers anyone understands.
KEEP QUIET	Every chart behind a tab or a hover.
THE ONE THING	None. Ratio is for looking; a goal can be changed from here.

Numbers are evidence, not grades. Each says what it counts and over how long. Where there isn't enough to say anything, Ratio says that kindly instead of drawing a flat line.

Ask yourself

1. *Does every number say what it counts, and since when?*
2. *Is a saved word ever called a known one?*
3. *Is any estimate labelled as one?*

TABS

Overview · Tabula · Iter, with a language filter. Charts in `src/design/charts`, each with a popover.

TABULA

The languages you speak, with level and notes; certificates can be added later.



CHAPTER 18

Settings and the plans

Everything you can change

Everything adjustable, in groups, with search, and the plans told straight.

SHOW FIRST	The groups, and the search.
KEEP QUIET	The fine options inside their group.
THE ONE THING	Find the setting.

Things with consequences are named for what they do. Cancelling a renewal, disconnecting a service and deleting everything are three different things, and they never share a button called Remove.

Ask yourself

1. *Can someone export, delete or manage a subscription without help?*
2. *Does each plan say its price, what it includes and when it renews, next to its button?*
3. *Is "Continue free" as easy to see as the rest?*

PLANS

Lingua+ €24.99 once, every update included. Max €5.99 a month or €49.99 a year: AI with your own key. Through Stripe.

NAME

Settings was called Ordo until 5.2-1.

PART FOUR

Before you call it done

The states a page can be in, Lingua's check, and a sheet to tick.



CHAPTER 19

Every page's states

A page is not done when it looks right full. It is done when it also looks right empty, slow, wrong and offline.

The first time	Say why it's empty, and give one way in.
Loading	Keep the page's shape. If it takes more than a moment, say what's happening.
Nothing found	Show what was searched for, and a way to clear it.
Went wrong	Keep what the learner typed, say what failed, and offer to try again.
Offline	Say what still works. Most of Lingua does.
Not in this plan	Say what it is and what it costs, and that saying no loses nothing.
Coming	Dimmed, with a word on hover. Never a button that does nothing.
A lot	Five hundred books, ten thousand words: does it still breathe?

PRIMITIVES

`EmptyState` for the first time and nothing found; `Toaster` for whispers.

KEYS

Stay on the device, travel only in request headers, never in a URL.

A toast is a whisper, not a record. Anything the learner must know stays on the page after the toast has gone.

Never show a stack trace, a key or someone else's anything.

CHAPTER 20

The check

Lingua's own check, for every page you touch. It takes ten minutes and saves the user an evening.

- [ ] `npm run typecheck`
- [ ] `npm test`
- [ ] `npm run build`

FROM

`CLAUDE.md`, "How the user wants each prompt handled".

Then look at it

- [ ] at 1280, 1440 and a 1366 × 768 laptop
- [ ] in Paper and in Nocturne, two palettes each
- [ ] with the language touches on and off
- [ ] with reduced motion on
- [ ] with the keyboard only: can you reach everything, and see where you are?
- [ ] with a long word, a long name, Arabic from right to left, and Japanese without spaces
- [ ] at Windows' 125% scaling

Then finish it

Update the docs it touches (the roadmap, decisions, features), tick the step in the handover, give the push its version, rebase, push, and check the site went live.

VERSION

`node scripts/version.ts "…"`; Lingua 6 is `0.6.0-alpha.N`. See `docs/VERSIONS.md`.

CHAPTER 21

The review sheet

Page _____ Date _____

THE SPIRIT

- [ ] The language is the biggest thing
- [ ] One main thing to do
- [ ] The rest folded, not taken away
- [ ] Nothing promised that isn't built
- [ ] Nothing added behind the learner's back

THE LOOK

- [ ] Tokens only; no colour by hand
- [ ] One terracotta thing per area
- [ ] Literata for the language and titles
- [ ] Lines before shadows
- [ ] Fits 1366 × 768, no tiny scroll
- [ ] Only transform and opacity move

THE WORDS

- [ ] The title asks or names
- [ ] At most one smile, never in an instruction
- [ ] Buttons say what happens
- [ ] Plain words for money, privacy, errors

THE STATES

- [ ] The first time
- [ ] Loading keeps the shape
- [ ] Nothing found, with a way back
- [ ] An error keeps what was typed
- [ ] Offline says what works
- [ ] Coming is dimmed, not dead

THE CHECK

- [ ] Typecheck, tests, build
- [ ] Paper and Nocturne, two palettes each
- [ ] Language touches on and off
- [ ] Reduced motion
- [ ] Keyboard only
- [ ] Right to left, and no spaces

NOTES

APPENDIX A

The numbers

Every value in one place, from `src/design/tokens.css`. The palettes change some of them; see `palettes.ts`.

TOKEN	PAPER	NOCTURNE	USED FOR
--bg	#faf6f0	#1f1c1a	the page
--surface	#efe7d9	#2b2724	cards, fields
--raised	#fffbf4	#35302c	things that float
--sunken	#e8dfcf	#191715	wells, tracks
--ink	#262220	#ebe0cc	text
--ink-soft	#5e554e	#bdb19f	second text, drawings
--ink-faint	#776c63	#918779	labels, hints
--line	#e1d6c4	#3b3532	hairlines
--line-strong	#cec0a9	#514944	field edges
--accent	#c86d51	#d49b54	the bookmark
--accent-text	#a5533b	#dba765	text in the accent
--sage	#6b8e78	#93b39e	known, done
--sage-text	#4f6f5b	#93b39e	text in sage
--inverse	#3b302a	#e8d8bb	toasts, tooltips
--on-inverse	#f8efe0	#2b231e	their text
--learning-bg	accent at 14%	accent at 17%	a word being learned
--scrim	ink at 28%	near-black at 45%	behind dialogs

Type

Serif	Literata Variable, Noto Serif Variable, Georgia	`--font-serif`
Sans	Plus Jakarta Sans Variable, Inter Variable, system-ui	`--font-sans`
Display	the language's heading face, else Literata	`--font-display`
Sizes	44 · 40 · 36 · 30 · 22 · 19 · 15 · 13.5 · 12.5 · 11.5 px	

Corners and light

Corners	8 · 12 · 16 (buttons by size, small panels) · 20 (side panels) · 24 (cards, dialogs, the map) · full (pills)
elev-1	0 1 2 ink/6%, 0 2 8 ink/5%
elev-2	0 2 6 ink/7%, 0 12 32 ink/10%
elev-3	0 8 24 ink/11%, 0 28 72 ink/17%

Motion

snappy	560 · 42 · mass 0.8	soft	320 · 34
sheet	400 · 40 · mass 0.9	gentle	200 · 28
fluid	210 · 26 · mass 1	fade	0.16 s, ease 0.2 0 0 1
page	y 8 → 0 on soft	full	y 18, scale 0.985, on fluid

Screens and keys

Check at	1280 · 1440 · 1366 × 768, light and dark
Rooms	Alt 1–8, in the sidebar's order
Cursus tabs	1–4
Contrast	4.5 : 1 for text; accent and sage text use their `-text` tokens

APPENDIX B

Words Lingua uses

Cursus	a course, a running. The course, grammar, alphabets, typing.
Codex	a bound book. Reading.
Thesaurus	a treasury. Your words and decks.
Ludus	a game, and a school. The games with your words.
Sonus et Visio	sound and sight. Listening and watching.
Mentis	of the mind. Mundus (the world: the guide), Sermo (talk), Diarium (a daily record).
Grammatica	grammar, in Cursus.
Ratio	a reckoning. Overview, Tabula (a writing tablet: the languages you speak), Iter (a journey).
Ordo	order. Settings' old name.
Paper, Nocturne	the light and the dark.
Palette, paper	a colour set for each light; a page colour for reading.
Language touch	a flavour: a heading face, an ornament, a lean of the accent.
Tiers	Core, Full, Beta, Basics, Experimental: how much Lingua has for a language.
Lingua+	everything, once, €24.99.
Max	the AI features, with your own key, €5.99 a month or €49.99 a year.
Next up	Home's list of one-click ways back in.
The word drawer	what opens when you tap a word.
A0 to C2	the levels; A0 is "starting out".

APPENDIX C

Lingua 6 at a glance

THE PLAN

`docs/LINGUA-6-PLAN.md`. The queue: `docs/HANDOVER.md`.

A design update, one room at a time. Each step is planned from the user's notes, then built, then checked against this book.

STEP	WHAT	WHERE IT STANDS
6-0	This handbook	*done*
6-1	The first start	*planned*
6-2	Home	*waits for notes*
6-3	Cursus	*waits for notes*
6-4	Codex	*waits for notes*
6-5	Thesaurus and Ludus	*waits for notes*
6-6	Sonus et Visio	*waits for notes*
6-7	Mentis	*waits for notes*
6-8	Ratio	*waits for notes*
6-9	Settings and the plans	*waits for notes*
6-10	The states, everywhere	*waits for notes*
6-11	The check; version 0.6.0	*last*

PRINT

`node scripts/handbook-pdf.ts`

When a step changes a rule in this book, the book changes in the same commit. Then print it again.

FOR YOUR NOTES AND SKETCHES



Set in Literata and Plus Jakarta Sans, the faces Lingua is set in, on Lingua's own Cream. Drawn with one fine line.

LINGUA · DOCS/HANDBOOK